



ENTERTAINMENT NEXT Making movies for the world

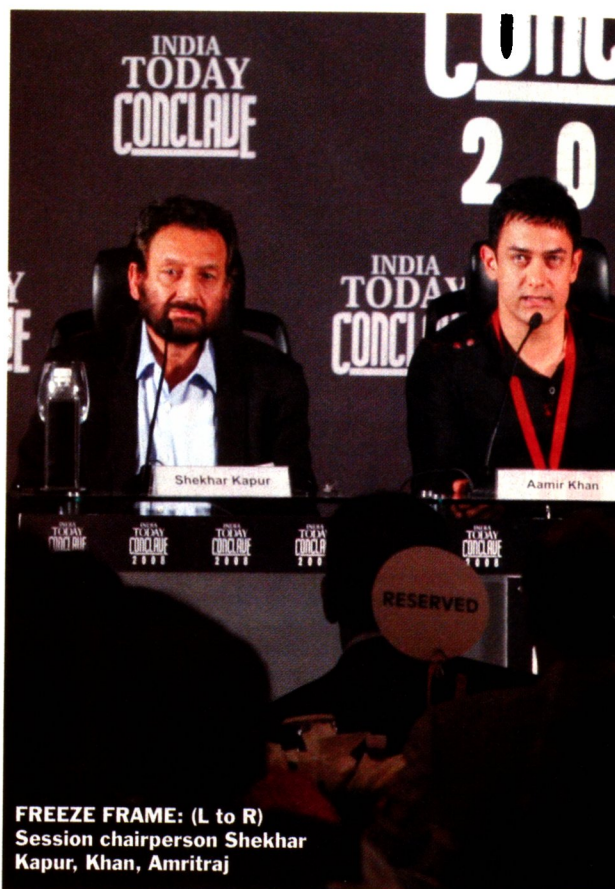
**"I want people to be moved
by what I am saying"**

AAMIR KHAN ACTOR, DIRECTOR & PRODUCER

Conventionally, we have made films for an Indian audience or for people in Pakistan, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka who watch Indian films. We have great talent and I think that our audience is so large that we have never felt the need as filmmakers to look outside to another audience. Yet, Indian cinema, especially from the 50s, has had an impact across the world without the producers intending it, for example Raj Kapoor. When I went to Morocco for the first time—this was in 2002 or 2003—I was the guy getting mobbed and not Francis Ford Copolla. No one knew who Copolla was. Indian cinema has managed to touch a chord with audiences in certain parts of the globe. That is wonderful. But for us to reach a stage to entertain a world audience, we will have to look at them seriously. Emotionally, I connect with the audience whom I have been entertaining for over the past 20 years now. There isn't really an urge in me to try and entertain a world audience. It has to happen organically.

But looking inwards at how the industry is changing, the key is, as a corporation, if I have to make 15 films a year, I have to develop a hundred scripts to finally end up with the ones worth making. Also what is happening here is that these corporations have suddenly come in on the scene. They are corporate babies. So you have money, but you don't know what to do with it and you have to quickly make films. People who can greenlight a project have to have creative experience. For example, if I am someone who belongs to the telecom business and have been brought in to look after an entertainment company, I may know how to deal with people and big organisations, but I may not know which script to pick. So you need people up there.

If I were to say to a corporate that I want to make a film about child care and education, which is basically *Taare Zameen Par*, most of them would refuse. Like they would look at *Lagaan* which broke every requirement of mainstream cinema till then—it was a period film on sports in Awadhi. It was set in Bhuj with people wearing dhosis while the norm was Switzerland and DKNY labels. When your company has the ability to pick a script, then you have arrived as a corporate. I react to a script as an audience. I go with my gut. If it moves me, then I want to make it. How will entertainment next be



HEMANT CHAWLA

FREEZE FRAME: (L to R)
Session chairperson Shekhar Kapur, Khan, Amritraj

delivered? Cinema is simply storytelling. With new technologies coming in, there are new options for creative people. But I would be really surprised if down the years we find that cinema no longer exists in theatres. Cinema is probably the youngest art form today. It incorporates all the previous art forms that have existed and grown over the centuries. While you will have Internet content and mobile content, a lot of it will again be from films, whether it is Shah Rukh Khan's latest song or Hrithik Roshan's latest photograph.

"New media is the key"

ASHOK AMRITRAJ PRODUCER

In the past 27 years I have been making films, I have seen different kinds of technology whether it was the VHS, the DVD, pay cable or satellite. In each case, box-office pundits pretty much said that it was doom and gloom for the box-office. Yet in each case new revenue streams were created. New media are going to increase the market enormously. They are also going to make things very democratic,